

The Healthspan *Imperative*

A fellowship for late-stage postdoctoral scientists who have made meaningful discoveries and are ready to envision an entrepreneurial future.

AWARD STRUCTURE

12 mo

FELLOWSHIP DURATION

\$100k

TOTAL AWARD

3–4

AWARDS IN 2026

Awards are administered through the fellow's home institution. No indirect costs are allowed. The award covers a competitive postdoctoral stipend for 1 year, as they embark on their independent scientific careers.

What We Fund

We support postdoctoral research with clear translational potential across six domains:

Fundamental Aging Biology Senescence, stem cell exhaustion, mitochondrial dysfunction, epigenetic reprogramming, proteostasis, autophagy, inflammaging	Preventive Geroscience Biomarkers of biological aging, healthspan-extending interventions, exercise and nutrition biology, microbiome–aging axis	Disease-Specific Research Neurodegeneration, cardiovascular aging, metabolic disease (diabetes, obesity, NASH), cancer survivorship, musculoskeletal aging, immunosenescence
Organ & Tissue Rejuvenation Cell therapies, tissue engineering, organoid models, partial reprogramming, blood-borne factors, organ-specific aging mechanisms	Translational Tools & Technologies Drug discovery platforms, high-throughput screening, AI/ML approaches, novel delivery systems, diagnostics and wearables for frailty	Fundamental Molecular Mechanisms New biology including RNA biology, molecular condensates, structural insights, and novel molecular pathways underlying aging

KEY DATES · 2026 CYCLE

Deadlines & Timeline

July 1, 2026

Full Application Deadline
11:59 PM Pacific Time · Submit by email to applications@criticalmassventures.co
All materials including reference letters must be received by this date.


criticalmassventures.co